

Research Proposal Page 1

Tips Before Starting

- Check the word count of the institution you are applying to and what is included (tables/references)
- They might have specific instructions they want you to include, e.g, how you meet specific criteria (lab experience, publications etc)
- If your application is for funded research under a PI/as part of a wider lab, then read up on their research and how your proposal fits!
- If you are applying for self-funded research, you will need to identify a 'potential supervisor' before you apply! Make sure you read their research and why they would be a good fit

THE PROPOSAL

What is your “**why?**”

You need to harness **your reason for conducting this research**. Why is it important/nuanced/original?

Include your **research question(s), aims, and hypotheses**. Explain how your **research methodology** and how it will not only 'fit' but also 'aim to develop'

Everything you write needs to be **thoroughly researched and cited**. Do not state anything without an **accurate, reliable citation**.

Thus, you do need a **mini literature review** which positions 'background' in the field. **You must include a project timeline also!**

Research Proposal Page 2

Title/ Background

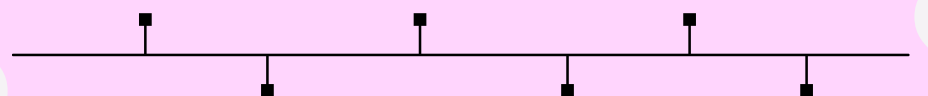
- **Title:** Convey your research in a snappy title, you will likely change this!
- **Background:** Broad 2-3 paragraphs which provide context/appropriate background of your research position/topic

Project Summary

- You are justifying to the university/PI/potential supervisors why your project should be considered - your research question, aims, hypotheses (if necessary), your methodology: sample, participants, recruitment, materials, stimuli, experimental procedure etc it all needs to go in here (and your novelty)

Proposed Timeline

- Provide something visual for those reading this - include a gantt chart or a visual timeline to show your competency in a) planning, b) prioritising, and c) that you can look ahead from the start to finish of a long 3+ year project!



Research Proposal Page 3

Proposed Publications

- **Not always required - depends on institution and type of degree**
- If required you can list the potential publications that could come from this research and the impact that could have

References

You need a full list of references - written in the field's citation style.

Additional Tips

- **Start with a statistic, something that immediately conveys the importance of your research**

- **Explain WHY this research is needed. WHAT will this research achieve in a broader sense?**

- **Provide detailed justification of your methodological choices - it is bound to come up in your interview!**

- **Write clearly and accessibly! Do not use jargon or abbreviations unless absolutely necessary.**